

GUIDELINES FOR THE PREPARATION OF REPORTS BY MEMBER STATES ON THE APPLICATION OF THE 1960 CONVENTION AND RECOMMENDATION AGAINST DISCRIMINATION IN EDUCATION

Preparation of the 11th Consultation

Combating discrimination in education

Eleventh consultation of Member States on the application of the Convention and the Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (1960) (2024-2025)

GUIDELINES FOR THE PREPARATION OF REPORTS BY MEMBER STATES ON THE APPLICATION OF THE 1960 CONVENTION AND RECOMMENDATION AGAINST DISCRIMINATION IN EDUCATION

1. Introduction

The Convention against Discrimination in Education ("the Convention") and the Recommendation against Discrimination in Education ("the Recommendation"), adopted by UNESCO's General Conference in 1960, are aligned with UNESCO's constitutional mandate to "advance the ideal of equality of educational opportunities without regard to race, sex or any distinctions, economic or social". The Convention is the first legally binding international instrument focused on the **right to education** and the only one exclusively dedicated to it.

The right to education is one of the key principles underpinning the Education 2030 agenda and Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG4) adopted by the international community in 2015. SDG 4 seeks to ensure the full enjoyment of the right to education as fundamental to achieving sustainable development. Its scope captures the multidimensional nature of the right to education.

Representing a powerful tool to advance SDG 4 by ensuring effective articulation between normative and operational work, the Convention has been recognized as a cornerstone of Education 2030 agenda.

The present Guidelines are intended to assist Member States in the preparation of country reports on the implementation of the Convention and the Recommendation in the context of the 11th consultation.

2. Scope of the Consultation

Considering the Education 2030 agenda, the monitoring of the Convention and the Recommendation is of crucial importance to ensure an education that is truly inclusive for all and to counter persistent inequalities in access, participation and learning outcomes at all levels, particularly for the most vulnerable groups. This is particularly true under the current context in which countries are making efforts to recover from the learning disruption caused by the COVID-19 pandemic. Concrete measures taken by countries in accordance with their legal obligations under these instruments contribute to implementing the Education 2030 agenda.

As the scope and content of the legal obligations under the right to education are aligned with the 10 targets of SDG 4, efforts are being made to ensure that the components of the targets are included in the guidelines and that these guidelines serve as a valuable contribution to monitoring progress towards SDG 4 targets.

Beyond SDG 4, the Convention is also closely aligned with the normative content on the right to education of other international human rights instruments such as the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966), Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of

Discrimination against Women (1979), the Convention on the Rights of the Child (1989) and the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (2006).

In addition, this Consultation is an opportunity to inform the ongoing **UNESCO Initiative on the Evolving Right to Education within a lifelong learning perspective**¹ (launched in December 2021). The Initiative investigates how the right to education could be reinforced placing it within a lifelong learning perspective and in light of the new demands being placed on education. This Initiative builds on the **Report from the International Commission on the Futures of Education**², which suggests to broaden our understanding of the right to education to clearly apply it to all ages and across all times and spaces. The initiative is also in-line with the **Vision Statement of the United Nations Secretary General on Transforming Education**³, and the **Report on the 2022 Transforming Education Summit**⁴ which call for the transformation of education systems to 'include everyone, regardless of circumstance, context or background'. The Initiative on the Evolving Right to Education aims to open a collaborative and participatory discussion about the international framework to ensure the effective enforcement of the right to education and learning throughout life for all. Finally, the Initiative builds on recent inter-governmental dialogues, including the Marrakech Framework for Action for Adult Learning and Education⁵ and the Tashkent Declaration on Early Childhood Care and Education.⁶

It is also important to note that previous consultations on the Convention and Recommendation revealed that countries now understand the right to education in an extended manner. The 11th consultation builds on the findings of the previous national reports to include various areas that have direct repercussions on the right to education such as, for instance, digital learning, climate considerations, lifelong learning entitlement, and the role of non-state actors in education.

3. Reporting obligations

There are differences in the legal nature of the obligations under the Convention, as distinguished from those under the Recommendation. The Convention has binding force and the States Parties are under the obligation to incorporate its provisions into their domestic frameworks. The Recommendation, non-binding in nature, has political and moral force. Its adoption sought to take into account the difficulties that certain States might experience in ratifying the Convention, in particular with respect to their federal structure.

Bearing in mind the differences in legal scope inherent to the nature of these two categories of instruments, the content of the Recommendation is identical to that of the Convention. Member States are expected to give effect to it in national legislation and education policies.

The reporting obligation under the provisions of Article VII of the Convention and of the Recommendation is the same. Article VIII of UNESCO's Constitution states that "*Each Member State shall submit to the Organization, at such times and in such manner as shall be determined by the General Conference, reports on the laws, regulations and statistics relating to its educational, scientific and cultural institutions and activities, and on the action taken upon the recommendations and conventions referred to in Article IV, paragraph 4*". Therefore, even if a country is not a State Party to the Convention, it needs to submit a report on the implementation of the Recommendation, which means that **all UNESCO Member States are expected to submit a national report** on the implementation of these instruments in the context of monitoring consultations.

¹ <https://www.unesco.org/en/right-education/evolving>

² <https://unesdoc.unesco.org/ark:/48223/pf0000379707>

³ https://www.un.org/sites/un2.un.org/files/2022/09/sq_vision_statement_on_transforming_education.pdf

⁴ https://www.un.org/sites/un2.un.org/files/report_on_the_2022_transforming_education_summit.pdf

⁵ [Marrakech Framework for Action | Institute for Lifelong Learning \(unesco.org\)](https://www.unesco.org/en/marrakech-framework-for-action)

⁶ [Tashkent-declaration-ecce-2022.pdf \(unesco.org\)](https://www.unesco.org/en/tashkent-declaration-ecce-2022)

4. Participation in consultations

The reporting period for the 11th consultation on the implementation of the Convention and the Recommendation covers four years (2021-2024).

The Futures of Education Report calls for a new social contract for education, which requires to understand education as a common good and a shared societal endeavour. To ensure this, extensive consultations involving a broad range of stakeholders is needed. The reporting process therefore needs to be **participatory**. This includes ensuring cooperation between ministries of education and other ministries dealing with aspects of the right to education as well as consulting social partners and **civil society organizations** and other relevant bodies.

The preparation of national reports provides a **good opportunity** for Member States to assess the implementation of the right to education in their country, identify specific challenges, build constructive dialogue with other actors involved in this field and share good practices.

In the preparation of reports, Member States are encouraged to provide **substantive and relevant information in a concise manner**. In addition to a description of the constitutional, legislative, administrative, and policy framework established for the implementation of the provisions guaranteed by the instruments, the information supplied by Member States should demonstrate how legal norms and practices comply with the Convention and the Recommendation.

Relevant information supplied for other reporting instances may be reproduced or referred to with precise indication as to its retrieval. Similarly, hyperlinks to any useful documents or relevant legal and policy texts are most welcome and texts can also be added in the annex.

Country reports submitted for previous consultations can be found on the **Observatory on the right to education**⁷ in the monitoring section of the country profile. The information provided in the reports are valuable both for the Observatory on the right to education as well as for **HerAtlas**⁸, the online monitoring tool for girls' and women's right to education. Information and data regarding countries' education systems are also available through the UNESCO Institute for Statistics database⁹. Beyond monitoring purposes, the consultation findings and reports inform broader work - serving for knowledge generation, advocacy, and technical cooperation.

5. Modalities and structure

The Guidelines are structured around three chapters:

- The **first chapter** covers general information on adherence to the Convention.
- The **second chapter** aims to gather information on the implementation of the Convention and Recommendation in the context of Sustainable Development Goal 4. As the most extensive part of the Guidelines, this chapter covers: inclusion and non-discrimination in education (section 1), all levels and forms of education (section 2), quality education provision and learning environment (section 3) and finally, strengthening governance systems (section 4).
- The **third chapter** seeks to obtain information on the methods used to draw the attention of the various authorities in the country to the instruments.

With a view to simplify the Guidelines while providing necessary substantive information to assist Member States in the preparation of responses, through a participatory process, **two types of guidance** are provided:

⁷ <http://www.unesco.org/education/edurights/index.php?action=home&lng=en>

⁸ <https://en.unesco.org/education/girls-women-rights>

⁹ [UIS Statistics \(unesco.org\)](https://uis.unesco.org/)

- (1) Open-ended and closed-ended questions to be directly filled in by Member States. Please note that multiple answers may be provided where relevant.
- (2) Additional information aimed at guiding Members States to structure and detail their responses to the open-ended questions (including remarks on how to respond efficiently to the questions raised). These elements are presented in italics.

GENERAL INFORMATION:

Country name: NIGERIA

Organization or entity responsible for the preparation of the report: NIGERIAN NATIONAL COMMISSION FOR UNESCO

Name of contact person: Dr. Olagunju Idowu Lateef

Email and telephone number of contact person: natcom.unesco@education.gov.ng +234 813 621 9701

I. Ratification and applicability of the Convention against Discrimination in Education¹⁰

- Is your country a State Party to the Convention?

☒ Yes

☐ No: Does your country plan to ratify this instrument?

☐ Yes: Please indicate the stage of ratification process reached by your country and whether assistance is needed:

☐ There is interest but no concrete action has been taken

☐ The ratification process has been initiated

☒ The ratification process is close to completion

- Please briefly explain the steps that have been taken and timeline when relevant, any difficulties encountered (legal, institutional, political or practical) in completing the ratification process. And how UNESCO can assist:

1. Rectification of CADE (1961)

2. Establishment of the Universal Primary Education (UPE) in 1976

3. Introduction of National Curriculum (1977)

Reforms and Initiative

1. Introduction of 6334 Education System (1982)

2. Establishment of the Board for Technical Education (NBTE) (1984)

3. Launch of National Primary Education Commission (1990)

4. Introduction of Universal Basic Education (UBE) Programme (1999)

Millennium Development Goal (MDGs) Era (2000-2015)

1. Development of the National Education Sector Plan (NESP) 2003

¹⁰ <https://www.unesco.org/en/legal-affairs/convention-against-discrimination-education>

2. Launching of Girls Education Initiatives 2004
3. Establishment of Universal Basic Education Commission 2004
4. Introduction of Conditional Cash Transfer for Girls Education 2012

SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS (SDGs) Era (2015-ongoing)

1. Development of National Policy on Education (2017)
2. Introduction of Home-Grown School Feeding Programme (HGFSP 2016)
3. Establishment of National Commission for Colleges of Education (NCCE 2017)
4. Launching of Education for Change Initiative (2018)
5. Renewed Hope Agenda in Education (2023)

EDUCATION LAWS AND POLICIES

Universal Primary Education Act 1976

National Policy on Education 1981

Universal Basic Education Act 2004

National Policy on Education 2017

Note: Child's Right Act (2023); 24 out of 36 states of Nigeria have adopted the CRA as a state law.

☐ No, not considering ratification. [Please explain why:](#)

- Is the Convention directly applicable in your country's domestic law?

☒ Yes ☐ No

- Have courts, tribunals and/or administrative authorities adjudicated on issues or violations regarding the right to education?¹¹

☐ No

☒ Yes:

-Have the provisions of the Convention been invoked?

¹¹ Judicial mechanisms play an important role in enforcing the right to education by ensuring legal accountability and therefore contributing to the practical realization of the right to education.

☒ Yes No

- Please cite the case law and jurisprudence.

Information could also be given about the judicial, administrative and other competent authorities having jurisdiction with respect to the right to education.

Court Ruling

1. ECOWAS community court of justice ruling (2019): recognise the right to education as a justiciable in Nigeria
2. SERAP version Federal Government and UBEC: upheld the right to quality Education, Dignity, and Economic and Social Development

II. Information on the implementation of the Convention or Recommendation in the context of Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG4)

1. Towards an inclusive non-discriminatory education system

For reference: This section relates to the main purpose of the Convention/Recommendation that is to underscore the state obligation to proscribe any form of discrimination in education while promoting equality of educational opportunity as laid out in Articles/Paragraphs 1(1), 2 and 3 of the Convention/Recommendation.

It further corresponds to the overall aspiration of SDG4 which aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all” by 2030. While it covers all the SDG4 targets, it also specifically covers SDG target 4.5.¹²

- Please indicate whether the rights and principles laid out in the Convention/Recommendation informed the elaboration of the education legal and/or policy framework:

☐ No ☒ Yes

- If yes, please provide reference:

1. National Policy on Education (1977, Revised 2013)
2. Universal Basic Education (UBE) Act (2004)
3. Child Rights Act (2003)
4. Persons with Disabilities (Equal opportunities etc) (2018)

1.1 Non-discrimination and equality in education

¹² Which calls on states to “eliminate gender disparities in education and ensure equal access to all levels of education and vocational training for the vulnerable, including persons with disabilities, indigenous peoples and children in vulnerable situations”.

- Please indicate measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation¹³, and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education (please tick all that apply):

For reference: This notably is covered under SDG target 4.1 and partly target 4.b¹⁴

☐ Legal texts¹⁵ prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education:

- ☒ In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)
- ☒ In primary education
- ☒ In secondary education
- ☒ In technical and vocational education and training
- ☒ In higher education
- ☒ In adult education and alternative learning

- Please indicate the relevant legal provisions:

Constitutional Provisions:

1. Section 18(1) of the 1999 Constitution of the Federal Republic of Nigeria: "Government shall direct its policy towards ensuring that there are equal and adequate educational opportunities at all levels."
2. Section 18(3): "Government shall promote science, technology, and education."
3. Section 42: Prohibits discrimination based on ethnicity, gender, religion, or social status.

Nigerian Laws:

1. National Policy on Education (2013): Emphasizes equal access to education.
2. Education (Free and Compulsory) Act (2010): Guarantees free and compulsory education.
3. Discrimination Against Persons with Disabilities (Prohibition) Act (2018): Protects rights of persons with disabilities.
4. Child Rights Act (2003): Ensures right to education for children.

Specific Provisions for Vulnerable Groups:

1. National Commission for Persons with Disabilities (NCPWD) Act (2018): Ensures inclusive education.

¹³ See: Article/Paragraph 1(1).

¹⁴ Which calls on states to "substantially expand globally the number of scholarships available [...] for enrolment in higher education, including vocational training and information and communications technology, technical, engineering and scientific programmes".

¹⁵ Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc.

2. Violence Against Persons (Prohibition) Act (2015): Protects girls and women from violence.
 3. Child Rights Act (2003): Protects children from exploitation
- Compulsory Basic Education—Universal Basic Education Commission (UBEC) ACT 2004

- Please list the prohibited grounds of discrimination in education as laid out in legal texts:

Constitution of the Federal Republic of Nigeria (1999)

1. Section 17(2)(a): Prohibits discrimination on grounds of "race, ethnic group, place of origin, sex, religion or political opinion".
2. Section 42: Prohibits discrimination in access to education based on "ethnic group, place of origin, sex, religion or political opinion".

Universal Basic Education (UBE) Act (2004)

1. Section 2(1): Ensures equal access to basic education without discrimination on grounds of "race, ethnicity, sex, religion, disability or socio-economic status".
2. Section 5(1): Prohibits discrimination in admission, treatment, or expulsion from basic education institutions.

Child Rights Act (2003)

1. Section 1(2): Recognizes the right to education without discrimination on grounds of "race, ethnicity, sex, religion, disability, birth or other status".
2. Section 15(1): Prohibits discrimination in education based on "race, ethnicity, sex, religion, disability or socio-economic status".

Persons with Disabilities (Equal Opportunities, etc.) Act (2018)

1. Section 2(1): Prohibits discrimination against persons with disabilities in education.
2. Section 7(1): Ensures equal access to education for persons with disabilities.

National Policy on Education (1977, revised 2013)

1. Section 3(1): Emphasizes equal access to education without discrimination on grounds of "race, ethnicity, sex, religion or socio-economic status".

Other Relevant Laws and Policies

1. The Violence Against Persons (Prohibition) Act (2015)
2. The Nigerian National Education Policy (2017)

3. The National Gender Policy (2006)

4. The National Policy on Special Needs Education (2015)

These legal texts collectively prohibit discrimination in education based on:

1. Race

2. Ethnicity

3. Place of origin

4. Sex

5. Religion

6. Political opinion

7. Disability

8. Socio-economic status

9. Birth or other status

☐ Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education

☒ In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)

☒ In primary education

☒ In secondary education

☒ In technical and vocational education and training

☒ In higher education

☒ In adult education and alternative learning

- Please provide details:

Policies:

1. National Policy on Education (1977, revised 2013)

2. Universal Basic Education (UBE) Act (2004)

3. Child Rights Act (2003)

4. Persons with Disabilities (Equal Opportunities, etc.) Act (2018)

5. National Policy on Gender in Education (2021)

6. National policy on inclusive education (2015, revised 2023)

Programs:

1. Universal Basic Education (UBE) Program
2. National Education Sector Plan (2018-2022)
3. Education for Change: A Ministerial Strategic Plan (2016-2019)
4. Girls' Education Initiative (GEI)
5. National Policy on Special Needs (NPSN)

Initiatives:

1. Safe Schools Initiative
 2. Education in Emergencies (EiE) Program
 3. Inclusive Education Initiative
 4. Gender Equality and Girls' Education Initiative
 5. Teacher Development Programme
- SDG 4.1 supported by UBEC ACT, 2004

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- ☐ Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum:
- ☒ In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)
- ☒ In primary education
- ☒ In secondary education
- ☒ In technical and vocational education and training
- ☒ In higher education
- ☒ In adult education and alternative learning

- Please provide details:

There is a National Curriculum for Basic 1-9 and SS 1-3 for all subjects by Nigerian Educational Research Development Council (NERDC).

At the University level, there is Core Curriculum Minimum Academic Standards (CCMAS)

Policy Reforms

1. Review and revise curriculum to eliminate biases and stereotypes.
2. Incorporate inclusive and diverse perspectives.
3. Ensure representation of various cultures, religions, and abilities.

Inclusive Education

1. Integrate special needs education.
2. Address gender and sexuality issues.
3. Foster critical thinking and empathy.

Teacher Training

1. Educate teachers on diversity and inclusion.
2. Provide resources for addressing bias.
3. Encourage culturally responsive teaching.

Textbook Review

1. Analyze textbooks for discriminatory content.
2. Replace or revise offending materials.
3. Ensure accurate representation.

Community Engagement

1. Involve parents, community leaders, and students.
2. Foster dialogue on diversity and inclusion.
3. Encourage inclusive practices.

Legislative Framework

1. Enforce laws against discrimination (Child Rights Act, Persons with Disabilities Act).
2. Develop policies promoting inclusive education.

Curriculum Framework

1. Nigerian Curriculum Framework (2013)
2. National Education Policy (2017)
3. Special Needs Education Policy (2015)

☐ Other measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education:

Constitution of the Federal Republic of Nigeria (1999)

1. Section 17(2)(a): Prohibits discrimination on grounds of "race, ethnic group, place of origin, sex, religion or political opinion".

2. Section 42: Prohibits discrimination in access to education based on "ethnic group, place of origin, sex, religion or political opinion".

Universal Basic Education (UBE) Act (2004)

1. Section 2(1): Ensures equal access to basic education without discrimination on grounds of "race, ethnicity, sex, religion, disability or socio-economic status".

2. Section 5(1): Prohibits discrimination in admission, treatment, or expulsion from basic education institutions.

Child Rights Act (2003)

1. Section 1(2): Recognizes the right to education without discrimination on grounds of "race, ethnicity, sex, religion, disability, birth or other status".

2. Section 15(1): Prohibits discrimination in education based on "race, ethnicity, sex, religion, disability or socio-economic status".

Persons with Disabilities (Equal Opportunities, etc.) Act (2018)

1. Section 2(1): Prohibits discrimination against persons with disabilities in education.

2. Section 7(1): Ensures equal access to education for persons with disabilities.

National Policy on Education (1977, revised 2013)

1. Section 3(1): Emphasizes equal access to education without discrimination on grounds of "race, ethnicity, sex, religion or socio-economic status".

Other Relevant Laws and Policies

1. The Violence Against Persons (Prohibition) Act (2015)

2. The Nigerian National Education Policy (2017)

3. The National Gender Policy (2006)

4. The National Policy on Special Needs Education (2015)

These legal texts collectively prohibit discrimination in education based on:

1. Race

2. Ethnicity

3. Place of origin

4. Sex

5. Religion

- 6. Political opinion
- 7. Disability
- 8. Socio-economic status
- 9. Birth or other status

1.2 Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education

- Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (*several items may be ticked*):

General measures:

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☒ Legislation provides for inclusive education for all | ☐ Multiple and flexible learning pathways ¹⁷ are provided for |
| ☒ Policy measures aim to enhance inclusion in education for all | ☒ Curricula and teaching methods are inclusive in design ¹⁸ |
| ☒ Teachers are trained on inclusive education ¹⁶ and to value diversity | ☒ Multilingual and intercultural education is supported |
| ☐ Initiatives to address discrimination and promote cultural diversity and mutual acceptance | |
| ☐ Other: | |

Legal Measures:

1. Child Rights Act (2003): Protects children's rights to education.
2. Persons with Disabilities (Equal Opportunities, etc.) Act (2018): Ensures inclusive education.
3. National Gender Policy (2006): Promotes gender equality.
4. Universal Basic Education (UBE) Act (2004): Free and compulsory basic education.
5. Constitution of the Federal Republic of Nigeria (1999): Guarantees right to education.

Policy Measures:

¹⁶ Teachers are prepared to teach all student (beyond just students with disabilities), equipping them with knowledge, values and attitudes that permit every student to succeed. See: [UNESCO policy paper](#): Inclusive teaching: preparing all teachers to teach all students, 2020, p.14.

¹⁷ Multiple and flexible learning pathways are 'entry points and re-entry points at all ages and all educational levels, strengthened links between formal and non-formal structures, and recognition, validation and accreditation of the knowledge, skills and competencies acquired through nonformal and informal education' ([Education 2030 Framework for Action](#), para. 33). This may include student transfers between courses and institutions and diverse learning modalities (online, in-person, full-time, part-time, etc.) to respond to individual needs and interests.

¹⁸ In designing the curricula and teaching methods, care is given to ensure that all students are provided with an inclusive and supportive learning experience that offers them the opportunity to succeed whatever their background.

1. National Policy on Education (1977, revised 2013): Emphasizes inclusive education.
 2. Universal Basic Education (UBE) Policy (2004): Focuses on equity and access.
 3. Special Needs Education Policy (2015): Supports inclusive education.
 4. National Education Sector Plan (2018-2022): Prioritizes equity and inclusion.
 5. Education for Change: A Ministerial Strategic Plan (2016-2019): Aims to improve access and quality.
 6. Education for Renewed Hope: Roadmap for the Nigerian Education Sector (2024 - 2027)
- SDG 4.1 & 4.2; National Policy on Education ensure the use of National Curriculum and native (immediate) language at Basic 1-3. National Teachers Institute (NTI) ensures training and re-training of teachers on national values.

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

- In general, what challenges were encountered in the implementation of non-discrimination and equal opportunities principles in education? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

- Cultural and societal biases: Deep-rooted cultural and societal biases against certain groups, such as women, people with disabilities, hinder equal opportunities in education.
2. Limited access to education: Inadequate funding, inadequate infrastructure, and scarcity of resources, particularly in rural areas, limit access to quality education.
 3. Gender disparities: Girls, particularly in northern Nigeria, face barriers to education due to cultural and religious beliefs.
 4. Disability-related barriers: Inadequate infrastructure and resources for students with disabilities restrict their access to inclusive education.
 5. Religious and ethnic tensions: Tensions and conflicts along religious and ethnic lines affect the learning environment and equal opportunities.
 6. Corruption and inadequate policy implementation: Corruption, inadequate funding, and lack of political will hinder effective policy implementation.

Quantitative information:

- According to UNICEF (2019), 60% of out-of-school children in Nigeria are girls.
- The Nigerian National Bureau of Statistics (2020) reported that people with disabilities face significant barriers, with only 5.7% having access to secondary education.

- The National Personnel Audit of Basic Education conducted by the UBEC (2018) stated that Nigeria has one of the highest rates of out-of-school children globally, with approximately 10.5 million children not attending school.

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☒ Legislation provides for gender equality in education | ☐ All barriers for pregnant girls and young mothers in education are eliminated to ensure the continuity of their education |
| ☒ Policy measures aim to enhance gender equality | ☐ Re-entry programmes for young mothers are provided for |
| ☐ Gender-responsive education sector planning is undertaken | ☐ Ensuring safe and adequate gender-sensitive sanitation facilities ²⁰ |
| ☒ Providing positive or affirmative action measures | ☐ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ²¹ and bias |
| ☐ Providing financial incentives and fellowships | ☒ Ensuring gender parity in science, technology, engineering and mathematics (STEM) |
| ☐ Teachers are trained (initial and in-service) on gender equality | ☒ Ensuring gender parity in technical and vocational training education and training (TVET) |
| ☐ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ¹⁹ | |
| ☐ Other: | |

This is supported by SDG 4.4 and 4.5. There is Girl-Child Scholarship at Tertiary Education. Adolescent Girls Initiative for Learning and Empowerment (AGILE) project helps to bring more girls back to classroom. Teaching of Science and Mathematics is encouraged in our secondary schools.

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

- What challenges were encountered in achieving gender equality in and through education? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

¹⁹ ' Stigmatisation is the act of treating someone or something unfairly by publicly disapproving of them' (Cambridge Dictionary).

²⁰ ' Gender-sensitive sanitation includes clean, safe and separate toilets, with access to water and garbage disposal' ([UNGEI blog post](#), Gender-sensitive sanitation, 2018)

²¹ Stereotype is a set idea that people have about what someone or something is like, especially an idea that is wrong' (Cambridge Dictionary).

- Does the legal minimum age for marriage conform to international standards (18 years) ²²:

Please note that child marriage is a discriminatory practice as often girls can marry at a younger age than boys. Child marriage violates the child's right to education as they are more likely to drop out of school and children who are not in school are more likely to get married.

☒ Yes ☐ No

- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions and indicate the exceptions to the legal age of marriage as well as the absolute minimum age:

The Nigerian Marriage Act of 1990 sets the legal age for statutory marriages, to be 18 years old for both males and females which conforms to international standards. However, customary and Islamic marriages have lower age limits, with girls as young as 12 and boys as young as 14 allowed to marry.

Also note that the minimum age for marriage is 18 for states (24) that domesticated Child Right Act in Nigeria. For exceptional cases, 16 years could apply.

National minorities:

For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities.

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☒ Legislation provides for the right to education of national minorities | ☐ Teachers are trained on intercultural education |
| ☒ Policy measures aim to enhance the right to education of national minorities | ☐ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ²⁴ |
| ☐ Policy elaboration includes consultations with local communities | ☒ Multilingual and intercultural education are supported |
| ☐ The right to carry out their own educational activities is legally guaranteed for national minorities | ☒ Native language instruction is ensured for national minorities |
| ☐ Educational standards are established for educational institutions run by national minorities | o Adapting curricula and teaching and learning methods to their needs for national minorities |
| ☐ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for national minorities | ☐ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ²⁵ and bias |
| ☐ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for national minorities | |

²² Please note that according to the Joint general recommendation No. 31 of the Committee on the Elimination of Discrimination against Women/general comment No. 18 of the Committee on the Rights of the Child on harmful practice, para. 20: "a marriage of a mature, capable child below 18 years of age may be allowed in exceptional circumstances, provided that the child is at least 16 years of age and that such decisions are made by a judge based on legitimate exceptional grounds defined by law and on the evidence of maturity, without deference to culture and tradition."

²⁴ Supra note 15.

²⁵ Supra note 16.

☐ Other²³:

National Policy on Education provides right to Education for all National Minorities. Equally, the Alternate School programme is designed to improve access to education as in SDG 4 to reduce 14 million Out-of-School children.

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of minorities? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

The NPE provides the teaching of pupils from 1-3 in the language of the immediate environment.

Indigenous people:

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☒ Legislation provides for the right to education of indigenous people | ☐ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for indigenous people |
| ☒ Policy measures aim to enhance the right to education of indigenous people | ☒ Teachers are trained on intercultural education |
| ☐ Policy elaboration includes consultations with local communities | ☒ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ²⁶ |
| ☐ The right to carry out their own educational activities is legally guaranteed for indigenous people | ☒ Multilingual and intercultural education are supported |
| ☐ Educational standards are established for educational institutions run by indigenous people | ☒ Native language instruction is ensured |
| ☐ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for indigenous people | ☐ Adapting curricula and teaching and learning methods to their needs for indigenous people |
| ☐ Other: | ☐ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ²⁷ and bias |

National Policy on Education and SDG 4.1 ensures access to free equitable and quality primary and secondary for all.

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

Legislative Framework:

1. National Policy on Education (2013): Ensures access to quality education for all, including vulnerable groups.

²³ Please see: [UNESCO report](#) 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023.

²⁶ Supra note 15.

²⁷ Supra note 16.

2. Child Rights Act (2003): Protects the right to education for children, including those displaced or affected by conflict.

3. Refugees and Asylum Seekers Protection Law (2011): Recognizes the right to education for refugees and asylum seekers.

Key Provisions:

1. Free and compulsory education for all children, regardless of nationality or immigration status.

2. Special provisions for internally displaced persons (IDPs), refugees, and asylum seekers.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of indigenous people? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Except for the 12 states in Nigeria who are yet to domesticate CRA.

Crises and conflicts across the country.

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations²⁸:

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☒ Legislation provides for their right to education | ☒ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for |
| ☒ Policy measures aim to enhance their right to education | ☒ Auxiliary assistance is provided |
| ☒ Inclusion in mainstream schools is ensured | ☒ Multiple and flexible learning pathways ³¹ are provided |
| ☒ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for | ☒ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ³² and bias |
| ☒ All administrative barriers to access education are removed | ☒ Accelerated learning programmes are provided |
| ☒ Alternative administrative procedures (placement tests, portfolio of evidence, etc.) to overcome administrative barriers ²⁹ are provided for | ☒ Non-formal and/or alternative education programmes are provided |
| ☐ Teachers are specifically trained to ensure their inclusion | ☒ Language classes to newcomers are provided for |
| | ☐ Multilingualism and intercultural education are encouraged |

²⁸ 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' ([UNESCO report](#): The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2).

²⁹ While lack of documentation (such as identity papers, birth certificates, residency permits, etc.) should not be an obstacle to access education, these can constitute a barrier to education See: [UNESCO publication](#): Handbook on the right to education, 2018, p. 96.

³¹ Supra note 13

³² Supra note 16.

☒ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation³⁰

☐ Other:

Counselling and auxiliary assistance are provided to them at Internally Displaced Camps.

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

- Have specific measures been adopted for climate displaced persons?

☒ No ☐ Yes

- Please elaborate:

Nigeria has acknowledged the need to address the root causes of displacement, including climate change, and ensure the safety of those affected. However, specific measures adopted for the education of climate-displaced persons in Nigeria are not explicitly stated.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of migrants, refugees, asylum seekers, stateless persons and IDPs? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Common Challenges:

1. Boko Haram insurgency displacing millions
2. Overcrowding in IDP camps and refugee settlements
3. Insufficient funding and resources
4. Inadequate teacher training and capacity building
5. Limited alternative education programs

Quantitative Information:

- Over 2 million IDPs in Nigeria (IOM, 2022)
- 245,000 refugee children in Nigeria (UNHCR, 2022)
- 60% of IDP children lack access to education (UNICEF, 2020)
- 40% of refugee children enrolled in school (UNHCR, 2022)

³⁰ Supra note 15.

People with disabilities:

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☒ It is free of charge for all. 1 Year No school fees, free learning Legislation provides for their right to education | ☐ Mainstream teachers are specifically trained on disabilities |
| ☒ Policy measures aim to enhance their right to education | ☒ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ³³ |
| ☒ Inclusion in mainstream schools is ensured | ☒ Auxiliary assistance is provided |
| ☒ Special schools are used as resource centers to inclusive schools | ☒ Curricula and teaching and learning methods re adapted |
| ☒ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided | ☒ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ³⁴ and bias |
| ☒ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided | ☒ Education infrastructure and learning materials are adapted |
| ☐ Other | |

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

Legal Measures:

1. Disability Rights Act (2018): Prohibits discrimination, ensures equal rights, and access to education.
2. National Commission for Persons with Disabilities (NCPWD) Act (2019): Establishes a commission to promote disability rights.
3. Child Rights Act (2003): Protects rights of children with disabilities.
4. Constitution of the Federal Republic of Nigeria (1999): Ensures equal rights and opportunities.

Policy Measures:

1. National Policy on Education (2013): Emphasizes inclusive education.
2. National Policy on Special Needs Education (2015): Guides special education delivery.
3. Inclusive Education Policy (2017): Promotes inclusive education.
4. National Disability Policy (2016): Addresses disability-related issues.

³³ Supra note 15.

³⁴ Supra note 16.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of people with disabilities? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Realizing the right to education for people with disabilities in Nigeria comes with several challenges, these include

Social Barriers i.e. stigma, discrimination, and negative attitudes from family and community members, leading to low self-esteem, depression, and isolation. For instance, some people believe that disabilities are a result of sinning or cultural and religious norms.

Economic Barriers also play a significant role, as many parents cannot afford to enroll their children with disabilities in school, and even when they do, the system is not inclusive enough to cater to their needs. This is reflected in the low literacy rates among adults with disabilities, with only 5% being literate ².

Infrastructure and Resource Challenges are also prevalent, including:

- Inadequate accessibility in schools and learning materials
- Limited trained teachers in special education
- Insufficient assistive devices
- Poor educational outcomes due to lack of adequate facilities

Students from poor households:

☒ Financial incentives and fellowships for school enrolment are provided

☒ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation³⁵

☐ Transport, meals and education material are subsidised or provided free of charge beyond compulsory education

☐ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes³⁶ and bias

☐ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided

☐ Other:

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

Actions taken to support the education of students from poor households in Nigeria include:

1. Universal Basic Education (UBE) Program: Provides free education to all children.

³⁵ Supra note 15.

³⁶ Supra note 16.

2. National Homegrown School Feeding Programme which provides a meal per day for primary school learners
3. Conditional Cash Transfer (CCT) Program: Offers financial assistance to poor households.
4. Education Trust Fund (ETF): Provides scholarships and grants.
5. Scholarships awards and financial aid by States and Federal Scholarship Boards
6. Free educational resources and materials (e.g., books, uniforms)
7. Vocational training and skills development
8. Payment of Senior Secondary School Certificate Examination fee for indigent students by their State Governments
9. Adolescent Girls Initiative for Learning and Empowerment (AGILE) project provides a variety of financial aids to students, parents, schools to help get girls back to school.
10. National Teachers' Institute (NTI) provides professional training and retraining to teachers.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of students from poor households? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Economic Challenges:

1. Poverty: Limited financial resources for school fees, materials, and uniforms.
2. Hunger and malnutrition which affects cognitive development and academic performance.
3. Child labour which forces children to work instead of attending school.

Access-Related Challenges:

1. Distance to schools: Long distances and inadequate transportation.
2. Limited school infrastructure: Overcrowding, poor conditions.
3. Inadequate teachers: Shortage and inadequate training.

Policy and Implementation Challenges:

1. Inadequate funding: Insufficient allocation for education.
2. Inefficient implementation: Weak monitoring, evaluation.

Quantitative Data:

- 60% of out-of-school children come from poor households (UNICEF, 2020).
- 40% of poor children complete primary education (World Bank, 2019).

- 20% of girls from poor households enroll in secondary education (UNICEF, 2020).

Regional Disparities:

1. North-South disparities: Northern regions have lower enrolment rates.
2. Urban-Rural disparities: Rural areas lack access to quality education.

2. Progress made with respect to implementing the right to education across all levels and forms of education

2.1 Early childhood care and education

For reference: Early childhood care and education (ECCE) is not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the international community has increasingly recognized the importance of ECCE over the years. The Committee on the Rights of the Child initially recognized “the right to education during early childhood as beginning at birth” (General Comment No. 7). This became more explicit with the 2010 Moscow Framework for Action and Cooperation³⁷ and more recently, the Tashkent Declaration and Commitments to Action for Transforming Early Childhood Care and Education³⁸. In the current context of the Education 2030 agenda, under SDG target 4.2, states have now committed to “the provision of at least one year of free and compulsory pre-primary education”.

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure access to quality ECCE (several items may be ticked):

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Prior to pre-primary education, ECCE services are free Not free | ☒ ECCE services respect a child’s need for early cognitive and social development, foundational learning, responsive care, nutrition, health, safety, protection, and play. |
| ☐ Prior to pre-primary education, ECCE services are affordable Not affordable because it is situated fully in the hands of private sector and social development services. | |
| ☒ ECCE services are accessible on a non-discriminatory basis Discriminatory because if you are poor you will not be able to access ECCE services. | |

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:

- (a) Provision of the following laws that ensure there are equal and adequate opportunities for children at all levels of education:
- The 1999 constitution of the Federal Republic of Nigeria
 - The Child Rights Act 2003
 - The Free and Compulsory Universal Basic Education Act 2004
 - States’ Basic Education Laws

³⁷ Which states that “ECCE is part of the right to education and the main foundation for holistic human development”.
³⁸ Which commits states to “Enhance policy and legal frameworks to ensure that the right to education includes ECCE”

- Basic Education Policies

(b) Activities, Programmes and Projects of the Federal, State and Local Governments, some of which includes the following

- Provision of quality learning environment
- Provision of instructional materials
- School feeding programme
- Teacher professional development
- Advocacy and Enrolment drive
- An integrated approach has been adopted for the care and support given to children 0-5yrs

- Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available?

- ☐ Pre-primary education is compulsory. Please provide the age of enrolment and duration:

Yes - age of enrolment is 5 years old, for a duration of 1 year

- ☐ Pre-primary education is **not** compulsory.

- ☐ Pre-primary education is free of charge for all. Please provide the duration and indicate the extent to which it is free:

- The Free and Compulsory Universal Basic Education policy. It is free of charge for all. 1 Year No school fees, free learning
- States' Basic Education policies materials in public schools.

- ☐ Pre-primary education is **not** free.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education?

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☒ Limited access | ☒ Poor learning outcomes |
| ☒ Issues of equity and inclusion | ☒ Low number of professionally trained educators |
| ☒ Poor quality programmes | ☒ Lack of support to families |
| ☐ Other: | |

Limited Infrastructures.

Cultural and Socio-economic barriers.

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

The UBE National Personnel Audit 2022 data showed the following gaps: • The percentage of good ECCDE classrooms was 56%. this shows there are not enough classrooms for ECCDE learners, also the learners' classroom ratio was 1:38 which is above the minimum standard of 1:25 • Gender Parity Index for ECCDE was 0.98. This shows that's an imbalance in the enrolment of Boys and Girls in Pre-Primary schools. • Nonbudgetary allocation, lack of infrastructure, poor political will.	
--	--

2.2 Primary and secondary education

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for universal primary and secondary education. In the context of the Education 2030 agenda, SDG target 4.1 calls on States to provide "12 years of free, publicly funded, inclusive, equitable, quality primary and secondary education – of which at least nine years are compulsory."

Primary education

- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of primary education:

Primary Education age of enrolment is 6 years old, for a duration of 6 years.

- Is primary education compulsory and free of charge?

- ☒ Primary education is compulsory
- ☐ Primary education is **not** compulsory.
- ☒ Primary education is free of charge.
- ☐ Primary education is **not** free.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

UBEC Act states that basic Education is free, practically, it is not free and primary school Heads charge the learners levies and different types of school charges which is against the Act.
--

Laws and Policies:

1. Universal Basic Education (UBE) Act (2004): Ensures free and compulsory basic education.
2. National Policy on Education (2013): Emphasizes access, equity, and quality.
3. Child Rights Act (2003): Protects children's right to education.
4. Tertiary Education Trust Fund (TETF) Act (2011): Supports tertiary education infrastructure.
5. States' Basic Education Laws

Direct Costs:

1. Enrollment fees (varies by institution and ownership):
 - Primary: ₦2,000 - ₦5,000 (approx. \$5-\$12 USD)
 - Secondary: ₦5,000 - ₦20,000 (approx. \$12-\$50 USD)
 - Tertiary: ₦20,000 - ₦100,000 (approx. \$50-\$250 USD)
2. Tuition fees (varies by institution):
 - Primary: ₦5,000 - ₦20,000 (approx. \$12-\$50 USD) per term
 - Secondary: ₦20,000 - ₦50,000 (approx. \$50-\$125 USD) per term
 - Tertiary: ₦50,000 - ₦200,000 (approx. \$125-\$500 USD) per semester

Indirect Costs:

1. Exam fees:
 - WAEC (West African Examination Council): ₦13,950 (approx. \$35 USD)
 - NECO (National Examination Council): ₦9,850 (approx. \$25 USD)
2. School supplies:
 - Uniforms: ₦5,000 - ₦10,000 (approx. \$12-\$25 USD)
 - Textbooks: ₦5,000 - ₦10,000 (approx. \$12-\$25 USD)

- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education?

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☒ Limited access | ☒ Poor learning outcomes in: |
| ☒ Issues of equity and inclusion | Foundation literacy |
| ☒ High dropout rates | Numeracy |
| ☒ Poor quality programmes | ☒ Social and emotional learning Others |

☐ Other:

☒ Disparity in learning outcomes

Low number of professionally trained teachers

The UBE National Personnel Audit 2022 data showed the following gaps:

- The percentage of good Primary classrooms was 52%. this shows there are not enough classrooms for primary learners, also the learners' classroom ratio was 1:60 which is above the minimum standard of 1:35
- Gender Parity Index for Primary was 0.96. This shows that's an imbalance in the enrolment of Boys and Girls in Primary schools. In some communities, the location of the Primary School is very far for the learners to access.

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

Challenges of primary education in Nigeria are numerous including:

Access-Related Challenges:

1. Distance to schools: 40% of children live over 3km from schools (UNICEF, 2020).
2. Limited school infrastructure: 30% of schools lack basic facilities (World Bank, 2019).
3. Inadequate classrooms: 50% of schools have overcrowded classrooms (NBS, 2020).

Quality-Related Challenges:

1. Teacher shortage: 40% of schools lack sufficient teachers (UNICEF, 2020).
2. Poor teacher training: 60% of teachers lack required qualifications (World Bank, 2019).
3. Inadequate learning materials: 70% of schools lack essential resources (NBS, 2020).

Financial Challenges:

1. Funding constraints: Education budget allocation reduced from 10.7% (2015) to 7.1% (2020).
2. Household poverty: 60% of households spend 10-20% of income on education (World Bank, 2019).
3. Fees and levies: Despite free education policies, households pay informal fees.

Social and Cultural Challenges:

1. Child labor: 15% of children engage in child labor (UNICEF, 2020).
2. Early marriage: 20% of girls marry before age 15 (UNFPA, 2020).
3. Cultural norms: Prioritizing work over education.

Quantitative Information:

- 10.5 million children out of school (UNICEF, 2020).
 - 60% of out-of-school children are girls (UNICEF, 2020).
 - 30% of primary schools lack basic sanitation facilities (World Bank, 2019).
 - 25% of primary school teachers lack required qualifications (NBS, 2020).
- Regional Disparities:**
1. North-South disparities: Northern regions have lower enrolment rates.
 - 2. Urban-Rural disparities: Rural areas lack access to quality education.
 - Some rural dwellers especially, the Northern part of the country, girls are not allowed to go to school because of socio-cultural factors including early marriage.

Secondary education

In this part, please provide information on the general availability and accessibility to all of secondary education, including technical and vocational secondary education and training.

- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of lower secondary education:

The lower secondary education age of enrolment is 12 years old, for a duration of 3 years.

- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of upper secondary education:

13-14 years for enrolment, 3 years for duration.

- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge?

- ☒ Lower secondary education is compulsory.
- ☐ Lower secondary education is **not** compulsory.
- ☐ Lower secondary education is free of charge.
- ☒ Lower secondary education is **not** free of charge.
- ☐ Upper secondary education is compulsory.
- ☒ Upper secondary education is **not** compulsory.
- ☐ Upper secondary education is free of charge
- ☒ Upper secondary education is **not** free of charge.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, schools supplies,

uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

In Nigeria, Lower Secondary School (Junior Secondary School, JSS) is compulsory and free, while Upper Secondary School (Senior Secondary School, SSS) is compulsory but not entirely free.

Relevant Laws and Policies:

- 1. Universal Basic Education (UBE) Act, 1999: Makes the first nine years of schooling (six years of primary education and three years of junior secondary education) compulsory and free.*
- 2. National Policy on Education (2013): Emphasizes access, equity, and quality in education.*
- 3. Section 15 (i) of the Child's right Act of 2003 states that every child has right to free, compulsory and universal Basic Education and shall be the duty of the Government of Nigeria to provide such education.*
 - i. Provide the child with diverse basic knowledge and skills for entrepreneurship and educational advancement.*
 - ii. Develop patriotic young people equipped to contribute to social development and the performance of their civil responsibilities.*
 - iii. Include rules and raise morally upright individuals capable of independent thinking and who appreciate the dignity of labour.*
 - iv. Inspire national consciousness and harmonious co-existence irrespective of difference in endowment, religion, colour, ethnic and socio-economic background.*

Compulsory and Free Education:

- 1. Primary Education (six years): Free and compulsory.*
- 2. Junior Secondary Education (three years): Free and compulsory.*

Upper Secondary Education (three years):

- 1. Compulsory, but not entirely free.*
- 2. Tuition fees apply in some state-owned and private schools.*

Direct Costs (Upper Secondary School):

- 1. Tuition fees: Varying amounts, depending on the institution (e.g., ₦25,000 - ₦50,000, approximately \$69 - \$138 USD per year).*
- 2. Enrolment fees: Varying amounts.*
- 3. Exam fees: Paid separately for senior secondary school exams (e.g., ₦13,950, approximately \$39 USD for WAEC).*

Indirect Costs:

- 1. School supplies: ₦5,000 - ₦10,000 (approximately \$14 - \$28 USD).*
- 2. Uniforms: ₦5,000 - ₦10,000 (approximately \$14 - \$28 USD).*

3. Transportation: ₦1,000 - ₦5,000 (approximately \$2.80 - \$14 USD monthly).

4. Compulsory levies on parents (e.g., PTA fees): ₦1,000 - ₦5,000 (approximately \$2.80 - \$14 USD).

Quantitative Information:

1. 60% of households spend 10-20% of income on education (World Bank, 2019).

2. Average household spending on education: ₦63,000 (approximately \$170 USD) per annum (NBS, 2020).

3. 20% of students drop out due to financial constraints (UNICEF, 2020).

- Please indicate whether the legal minimum age for employment is aligned with the end of compulsory education:

For reference: The employment laws and those related to compulsory education are interdependent and mutually reinforce each other. If the minimum age of employment is below that of compulsory education, the child is at risk of dropping out of school to work and therefore not completing compulsory education. On the other hand, if compulsory education is lower than the minimum age of employment, once the child has completed compulsory education, the door is open to child exploitation and the violation of labour laws.

☒ Yes ☐ No

- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions and indicate how the provision is enforced:

From the UBE Act 2004, the enrolment age for lower secondary school is 12 years and it is for a duration year.

According to the public service rules (PSR), the minimum age of employment is not to be less than 18 years

Labour Act of 1990, a person under 15 years of age shall not be employed or work in industrial undertakings which aligns with the Compulsory education in Nigeria that covers the first nine years of schooling, which includes six years of primary education and three years of junior secondary education

- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education?

☒ Limited access

☒ Issues of equity and inclusion

☒ High dropout rates

☒ Poor quality programmes

☐ Other:

☒ Poor learning outcomes

☒ Low readiness of primary graduates

☒ Low number of professionally trained teachers

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

The senior secondary schools notably cover the second component of the 3-3 educational system, with a 3-year duration officially catering for learners within the age bracket of 15-17 years.

1 NUMBER OF SENIOR SECONDARY SCHOOLS

Table a: Number of Public and Private Senior Secondary Schools by Year: 2019/2020 - 2021/2022

Year	Public	Private	Total
2019/2020	10,600	16,398	26,998
2020/2021	10,645	18,071	28,716
2021/2022	10,772	18,816	29,588

2 ENROLMENT FOR PUBLIC AND PRIVATE SENIOR SECONDARY

Table b: Enrolment in Public and Private Senior Secondary Schools by Sector and Gender: 2019/2020- 2021/2022

Year	Both		
	Male	Female	Total
2019/2020	2,925,875	2,805,269	5,731,144
2020/2021	3,089,541	2,957,293	6,046,834
2021/2022	3,132,832	3,001,816	6,134,648

2.3 Higher education

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3³⁹, and target 4.4⁴⁰. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training.

- Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items may be ticked):

- ☒ Higher education is free of charge
- ☒ Higher education is accessible on the basis of individual capacity (as assessed by reference to relevant qualifications and experience)
- ☒ Higher education is accessible through financial incentives and scholarships
- ☒ Higher education is accessible through positive or affirmative action measures
- ☒ Higher education is accessible through credit transfer system between states
- ☒ Higher education allows for multiple and flexible learning pathways (flexible entry and re-entry, recognition, validation, and accreditation of knowledge and skills acquired through non-formal and informal education).
- ☐ Other:

- Entry into higher qualification is broad on obtaining the entry requirement
- Scholarships exist but limited for higher education assessment
- Open Universities and Distance Learning, Direct entry/IJMB

Advising The Government for the establishment of more Universities and licencing of private universities

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, university supplies, transport, accommodation). Brief quantitative information may be added.

Relevant Laws and Policies:

1. National Policy on Education (2013)
2. Tertiary Education Trust Fund (TETFund) Act (2011)
3. National Universities Commission (NUC) Act (1974)
4. Federal Universities (Miscellaneous Provisions) Act (1993)
5. Education (National Minimum Standards and Establishment of Institutions) Act (2004)

³⁹ Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”.

⁴⁰ Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”.

6. Higher Education Act (1993)

7. Nigerian Universities Commission (NUC) Guidelines (2019)

8. National Board for Technical Education (NBTE) Act (1977)

9. National Commission for Colleges of Education (NCCE) Act (1989)

Direct Costs:

1. Tuition fees:

- Federal universities: ₦20,000 - ₦50,000 (\$50-\$125 USD) per semester
- State universities: ₦50,000 - ₦100,000 (\$125-\$250 USD) per semester
- Private universities: ₦200,000 - ₦500,000 (\$500-\$1,250 USD) per semester

2. Enrolment fees: ₦5,000 - ₦20,000 (\$12-\$50 USD)

3. Post-UTME fees: ₦2,000 - ₦5,000 (\$5-\$12 USD)

Indirect Costs:

1. Exam fees:

- WAEC: ₦13,950 (\$35 USD)
- JAMB: ₦3,500 (\$9 USD)
- NECO: ₦9,850 (\$25 USD)

2. University supplies: ₦10,000 - ₦20,000 (\$25-\$50 USD)

3. Transport: ₦5,000 - ₦10,000 (\$12-\$25 USD) per semester

4. Accommodation:

- On-campus: ₦20,000 - ₦50,000 (\$50-\$125 USD) per semester
- Off-campus: ₦50,000 - ₦100,000 (\$125-\$250 USD) per semester

Quantitative Information:

1. 60% of students enrol in federal universities (NUC, 2020)

2. Average tuition fee for federal universities: ₦35,000 (\$87 USD) per semester (TETF, 2020)

3. 70% of students receive financial assistance from parents or guardians (UNICEF, 2020)

4. 40% of students live off-campus (NBS, 2020)

- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education?

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☒ Limited access | ☒ Low number of professionally trained professors |
| ☒ Issues of equity and inclusion | |
| ☐ Poor quality programmes | ☐ Insufficient mechanisms to ensure smooth transition from secondary to tertiary |
| ☐ Poor learning outcomes | |
| ☐ Other: | |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

The UBE National Personnel Audit 2022 data showed the following gaps:

- The percentage of good Lower secondary education classrooms was 56%. this shows there are not enough classrooms for Lower secondary education learners, also the learners' classroom ratio was 1:64 which is above the minimum standard of 1:40.

Gender Parity Index for Lower secondary education was 1.06. This shows there is an imbalance in the enrolment of Boys and Girls in lower secondary schools.

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to "ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all", target 4.6 specifically calls on states to "ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy". Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called "to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life."

- Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (*several items may be ticked*):

- ☒ Provision of education for persons who have not received or completed the whole period of their primary education
- ☒ Provision of literacy programmes
- ☒ Provision of continuous learning (such as learning programmes to develop knowledge, skills, abilities, or competencies for personal and professional development)
- ☒ Provision of free of charge learning opportunities
- ☒ Provision of professional training including reskilling and upskilling programmes
- ☒ Recognition, validation and certification of non-formal and informal learning
- ☒ Provision of free of charge career guidance and counselling

☐ Lifelong learning entitlements including learning accounts, vouchers, etc.

☐ Other:

-Digitalization programmes;
-Empowerment and wealth generation programmes

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:

The Non-Governmental Association for Literacy Support services (NOGALSS) as an Umbrella organization of NGOs in Literacy Support Services has different categories of members implementing paid and free literacy programmes.

NOGALSS coordinates NGO activities, empowering them through meetings, training and capacity building; visits, joint advocacies, monitoring and evaluation, peer learning etc. for better and greater productivity.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education?

☒ Limited access

☒ Issues of equity and inclusion

☒ Poor quality programmes

☐ Other:

☒ Limited funding

☐ Poor learning outcomes

☒ Low number of professionally trained educators

-Limited resources (Financial and material) ☒
-Lack of knowledge and professionalism
-Lack of equity in access to financing of programmes

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

- ✓ Facilitators teach minimum 6 per week.
- ✓ Facilitators stipends range between \$10-20 a month
- ✓ Percentage of aid/budget to Non-Formal Education below recommended UNESCO standards for countries
- ✓ Subvention to non-state actors non-existent; which adds to the challenge of delivering literacy and numeracy and also reflects on poor learning outcomes

3. Quality education provision and learning environment

For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2, 4(b) and 5(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for quality education. Quality education is fundamental to achieve all targets of SDG4. It is also particularly highlighted in SDG target 4.a that recommends states to “build and upgrade education facilities that are child, disability and gender sensitive and provide safe, non-violent, inclusive and effective learning environments for all”.

3.1 General measures

- Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding:

- ☒ State monitoring and inspections
- ☒ Health and sanitation
- ☒ Safety (children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools))
- ☒ Infrastructure
- ☒ Curriculum
- ☒ Student-teacher ratio
- ☐ School fees (if relevant)
- ☐ Other Education provides minimum basic standards on the above items.

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- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

You may include information on policies, protocols or codes of conduct.

<i>In the context of Nigeria's education system, the 1960 UNESCO Convention against Discrimination in Education and the targets of SDG 4, specifically regarding quality education provision and learning environments.</i> State monitoring and inspections <i>In terms of state monitoring and inspections, the Federal Ministry of Education is responsible for overall policy formation and ensuring quality control ². The National Policy on Safety, Security, and Violence-Free Schools requires all schools to have a policy creating safe, secure, and violence-free settings for learners ². In Nigeria, the Federal Ministry of Education (FME), Universal Basic Education Commission (UBEC), in partnership with state education boards and National Teachers' Institute (NTI), oversees the monitoring of public schools to ensure compliance with national education standards</i> Health and Sanitation Standards: <i>Health and sanitation standards are mandated by the Federal Ministry of Education (FME), which requires schools to meet minimum hygiene standards, ensuring clean water, proper sanitation, and hygiene facilities.</i> <i>- Water and Sanitation: Access to clean water and sanitation facilities is mandatory in all public schools.</i>	
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- *Health Services: Schools are required to provide basic health services, including first aid and referrals to nearby health centers.*

- *Nutrition: Some schools offer meal programs to promote student nutrition and well-being.*

Key Safety Provisions (Children Learn in a Safe Environment Free from Violence or Harassment):

Legal Framework: The Nigerian government, through policies such as the Child Rights Act and the Safe Schools Declaration, promotes the safety of children in schools. Schools are required to provide safe, non-violent environments free from harassment, including gender-based violence.

- *Prevention and Response Mechanisms: Schools are required to establish mechanisms to prevent and respond to safety incidents ¹.*

- *Disaster Risk Reduction and Management: The policy emphasizes disaster risk reduction and management in schools ¹.*

- *Protection from Military Use: Nigeria has endorsed the Safe Schools Declaration, urging parties not to use schools for military purposes ².*

Key Factors Influencing Student-Teacher Ratio:

Legal Framework: The Nigerian education policy sets standards for student-teacher ratios to ensure effective learning. The optimal student-teacher ratio is a key focus area to improve the quality of education.

- *Rapid Population Growth: Nigeria's growing youth population puts pressure on the education system, leading to increased student numbers and strained resources ¹.*

- *Underfunding: Inadequate funding for education contributes to poor infrastructure, inadequate teacher training, and insufficient resources ¹.*

- *Regional Disparities: Variations in education quality and access exist between the oil-rich South and impoverished North, affecting student-teacher ratios ¹.*

Minimum Infrastructure Standards:

Legal Framework: The Federal Ministry of Education and UBEC work together to ensure public schools meet infrastructure standards, including the availability of adequate classrooms, proper ventilation, and learning resources. Target 4.a of SDG 4 also emphasizes the need for infrastructure that supports inclusive learning for all, including children with disabilities.

- *Classrooms and Library Facilities: The UBE Act mandates that all public schools have adequate classrooms and library facilities to support effective learning.*

- *Science and Technology Facilities: Public schools are required to have facilities for science and technology education, including laboratories and equipment.*

- *Sanitation and Hygiene Facilities: The Act emphasizes the importance of providing clean water and sanitation facilities in all public schools.*

Curriculum Standards:

Legal Framework: The Nigerian Educational Research and Development Council (NERDC) is responsible for developing the national curriculum. The curriculum is regularly updated to ensure it is relevant, inclusive, and aligned with global standards, including the SDG goals.

- Core Curriculum and Minimum Academic Standards (CCMAS): The NUC implements CCMAS to ensure universities design curricula and teaching methods that achieve education goals in Nigeria ⁴.

- Benchmark Minimum Academic Standards (BMAS): BMAS documents outline minimum academic standards for programs taught in Nigerian universities ^{2 3 5}.

- National Certificate in Education Minimum Standards: These standards guide curriculum development for teacher education programs ^{6 7}.

School fees

Legal Framework: Public primary and secondary education in Nigeria is free, as mandated by the Universal Basic Education Act. No school fees are required for basic education, although there may be incidental fees at higher education levels.

Federal Universities

In federal universities, school fees range from ₦34,200 to ₦144,500 ¹. For example, Abubakar Tafawa Balewa University, Bauchi, charges ₦44,250, while Nigerian Maritime University Okerenkoko, Delta State, charges ₦144,500.

State Universities

State universities have their own fee structures, with fees ranging from ₦22,800 to ₦378,500 ¹. For instance, Kano University of Science & Technology, Wudil, charges ₦22,800, while Edo State University Uzairue charges ₦378,500.

Private Universities

Private universities in Nigeria have significantly higher fees, ranging from ₦100,000 to ₦5,750,000 ¹. Achievers University, Owo, charges ₦400,000 – ₦800,000, while Nile University of Nigeria, Abuja, charges ₦2,400,000 – ₦5,750,000.

Inclusive Education:

In alignment with the Convention's provisions and SDG target 4.a, the Nigerian government promotes inclusive education, ensuring that children with disabilities have access to learning. The National Policy on Inclusive Education ensures that schools cater to the needs of all children. Nigerian government support the achievement of SDG 4, ensuring that education in Nigeria is inclusive, safe, and of high quality.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education?

☒ Non-supportive or inadequate learning environments

☒ Violence in schools

☒ Low quality educational infrastructure and materials

☒ Inadequate parental support to education

- ☒ Cost of education ☒ Long distances to schools
☒ Conflicts or crises
☐ Other:

Funding Issues

Outdated Curricula

Access to Education

Teacher Training and Development

Infrastructure

Digital Divide

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

Here are the challenges facing Nigeria's education system, along with some quantitative information:

1. Funding Issues

- 7.9% of Nigeria's 2022 budget was allocated to education, below the 15-20% recommended by UNESCO.
- 40% of schools lack basic infrastructure (UNICEF, 2020).

2. Corruption

- 20% of education funds are lost to corruption (Transparency International, 2019).
- 75% of Nigerian universities have been affected by corruption (National Universities Commission, 2019).

3. Outdated Curricula

- 60% of Nigerian graduates lack relevant skills for the job market (World Bank, 2018).
- 70% of schools use outdated textbooks (UNESCO, 2017).

4. Access to Education

- 10.5 million children are out of school (UNICEF, 2020).
- 61% of primary school-aged children in northern Nigeria are enrolled (UNICEF, 2020).

5. Teacher Training and Development

- 70% of Nigerian teachers lack qualifications (Teacher Development Programme, 2019).

- 30% of teachers are untrained (UNESCO, 2017).

6. Infrastructure

- 40% of schools lack basic infrastructure (UNICEF, 2020).

- 25% of schools lack access to water and sanitation (UNICEF, 2020).

*Between 2021 and 2024, **inadequate learning environments** remain a critical issue in Nigeria, particularly in rural and underserved areas. **Overcrowded classrooms, lack of adequate teaching materials, and poorly maintained infrastructure** continue to hinder educational quality. A joint UNICEF and Federal Ministry of Education report (2023) highlights the continued deterioration of school infrastructure due to insufficient funding.*

As of 2023, 60% of public primary schools still lack basic infrastructure, such as classrooms, chairs, and sanitation facilities. In rural areas, this figure rises to 75% (UNICEF, 2023).

"Many Nigerian children still study under trees or in makeshift classrooms, with minimal access to essential learning materials. The learning environment directly impacts the quality of education and student engagement." – UNICEF Nigeria Report, 2023.

7. Digital Divide

- 40% of Nigerians lack internet access (World Bank, 2020).

- 30% of schools lack computers (UNESCO, 2017).

8. Security Concerns

- 1,440 schools closed due to insecurity (UNICEF, 2020).

- 1,000 students abducted between 2020 and 2022 (SB Morgen, 2022).

Attacks by insurgent groups, particularly in the northern region, have continued to disrupt education, despite government efforts to increase security.

According to a 2022 report by the Global Coalition to Protect Education from Attack (GCPEA), more than 500 schools were attacked between 2021 and 2022, leading to the abduction of over 1,400 students. This has led to the closure of over 1,100 schools across the northern region.

***9. Conflicts**, especially in the North-East and North-West regions, continue to disrupt education. Despite government efforts, insurgencies, and armed conflicts by groups such as Boko Haram and bandits have displaced teachers and students, leading to school closures and a disruption of learning.*

By 2023, over 2.8 million children in Nigeria were displaced due to conflict, with 75% of them living in regions with little to no access to formal education (UNESCO, 2023).

*"The **ongoing insurgencies in Nigeria's northern regions** have had devastating effects on education. Many schools have been destroyed, and teachers have fled, leaving students with few alternatives for learning." – UNESCO Institute for Statistics, 2023.*

10. Societal Attitudes

- 30% of girls drop out due to early marriage (UNICEF, 2020).
- 20% of boys drop out due to child labor (ILO, 2019).

11. School-related violence, including bullying, harassment, and gender-based violence, remains a significant challenge in Nigeria.

12. Hidden costs of Education

While primary education is officially free in Nigeria, hidden costs such as uniforms, textbooks, and examination fees remain barriers to access, especially for low-income families. The economic challenges worsened by the COVID-19 pandemic and inflation have increased the financial burden on families.

A 2023 report by ActionAid Nigeria revealed that 52% of families in rural areas cannot afford the indirect costs of education, leading to a 25% increase in dropout rates for children aged 12-16.

"The cost of education continues to rise despite policies aimed at providing free primary education. Indirect costs have become prohibitive, particularly for families in rural communities." -ActionAid Nigeria, 2023.

13. Policy Implementation

- 50% of education policies are not implemented (National Institute for Educational Planning and Administration, 2020).
- 30% of education budgets are not released (Budget Office of the Federation, 2020)

The quality of school infrastructure and learning materials continues to be a challenge, despite government programs aimed at improving educational facilities. Many schools lack basic learning resources such as textbooks, and outdated or dilapidated buildings are a common sight in rural schools.

A 2022 report by the Federal Ministry of Education found that 40% of public schools still lacked textbooks and learning materials, while 45% of schools were in need of significant infrastructure repairs. Only 30% of schools had access to functioning science laboratories (FME, 2022).

"Many Nigerian schools still lack the basic infrastructure needed for a conducive learning environment. The absence of critical resources like textbooks and modern teaching aids continues to limit student learning." – Federal Ministry of Education Annual Report, 2022.

14. Parental support remains an essential factor in a child's educational success, but socio-economic challenges and cultural norms continue to undermine efforts, especially in rural areas. **Poverty, gender inequality, and misconceptions about the value of education—especially for girls—have persisted.**

A 2021 UNICEF study found that 36% of parents in rural Nigeria do not actively support their children's education due to economic pressures and cultural beliefs. In the North-

East, 53% of girls are not sent to school, largely because of traditional views on education for females (UNICEF, 2021).

"Parents in low-income and rural communities face tough choices. The need for children to contribute economically at home often outweighs the perceived value of schooling." – UNICEF, 2021.

Long travel distances to schools remain a significant barrier in rural areas, where schools are few and far between. The distance to the nearest school often discourages attendance, particularly for young children and girls, who may face safety concerns on their journey to school.

The National Bureau of Statistics (2022) reported that 25% of rural children travel over 5 kilometers to reach school, contributing to high absenteeism and dropout rates. In certain regions, this figure is as high as 40%.

*"The **distance to school** remains one of the most significant barriers to education for children in rural Nigeria, especially girls, who are often kept at home due to safety concerns." – NBS Education Report, 2022.*

From 2021 to 2024, Nigeria has faced continued and emerging challenges in delivering quality education, particularly in terms of infrastructure, conflict, and costs. However, continued investment and strategic interventions are crucial to overcoming these barriers and achieving SDG 4, ensuring inclusive, equitable, and quality education for all Nigerian children.

3.2 Education personnel

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to "substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers".

- Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked):

- ☒ Teacher training is provided without discrimination.
- ☒ Teachers' average salaries are competitive or at least comparable to those paid in other professions requiring similar or equivalent qualifications (at all levels).
- ☒ Initial training and continuous professional development are provided.
- ☒ Minimum standards and qualifications required for the teaching profession.
- ☒ Measures taken to strengthen the social status and attractiveness of the teaching profession.
- ☒ Measures taken to promote diversity in the teaching workforce, including to redress gender imbalances at different levels of education.
- ☒ Establishment of performance monitoring systems.
- ☒ Measures taken to increase women in leadership positions in education.
- ☐ Other:

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

In the Nigerian education system, there is improvement in the quality of education personnel, particularly through teacher training and professional development. The following measures are aligned with Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the 1960 Convention against Discrimination in Education and SDG target 4.c, which focuses on increasing the supply of qualified teachers and enhancing their professional conditions.

1. Teacher Training is Provided Without Discrimination

The teacher training is offered without any form of discrimination based on gender, ethnicity, religion, or socio-economic status, adhering to principles of equality and inclusiveness, ensuring access to training programs for all eligible teachers across the country.

2. Teachers' Average Salaries are Competitive

While salaries of Nigerian teachers, particularly in public schools, have not always been competitive, there have been government-led initiatives to improve the pay structure and ensure that teacher remuneration is comparable to other professions requiring similar qualifications. However, significant disparities still exist, particularly between public and private schools.

In 2022, the Federal Government announced salary increments for public school teachers as part of a broader effort to improve working conditions and retain qualified personnel. This initiative seeks to align teachers' wages with other professions requiring similar qualifications.

3. Initial Training and Continuous Professional Development (CPD) are Provided

There is a consistently offered initial teacher training and continuous professional development (CPD), which is a key measure in ensuring that teachers at all levels are well-equipped with modern pedagogical skills and content knowledge.

In line with SDG 4.c, FME through some Agencies provides continuous training through distance learning programs, workshops, and the Strengthening Mathematics and Science Education (SMASE) INSET programs. From 2021 to 2024, more than 100,000 teachers have benefited from CPD opportunities.

4. Minimum Standards and Qualifications Required for the Teaching Profession

The Teachers Registration Council of Nigeria (TRCN), in collaboration with the NTI, sets and enforces minimum standards and qualifications for entering the teaching profession. The TRCN mandates that all teachers must possess at least a Nigeria Certificate in Education (NCE) or equivalent to be professionally qualified while NTI plays a key role in helping unqualified or underqualified teachers upgrade their qualifications to meet the TRCN standards. The NTI offers tailored programs such as Postgraduate Diplomas in Education (PGDE) for teachers needing additional qualifications.

5. Measures Taken to Strengthen the Social Status and Attractiveness of the Teaching Profession

To enhance the attractiveness of teaching as a profession, the Nigerian government introduced various measures, including better remuneration, improved career paths, and public campaigns highlighting the importance of education.

In 2022, the Federal Government introduced a new retirement age for teachers, extending it from 60 to 65 years, as well as extending the years of service from 35 to 40. This policy is intended to enhance job security and make teaching a more attractive career choice.

6. Measures Taken to Promote Diversity in the Teaching Workforce

Diversity in the teaching workforce is actively promoted by ensuring representation across Nigeria's diverse ethnic and cultural groups, as well as ensuring gender balance in teacher recruitment and leadership roles. Between 2021 and 2024, women comprised 55% of participants in NTI's teacher training programs, indicating efforts to close the gender gap in education, especially at the primary and secondary school levels (NTI Report, 2023).

7. Establishment of Performance Monitoring Systems

Performance monitoring of teachers has been emphasized in recent years, to assess teacher effectiveness and ensure quality teaching. In collaboration with the Universal Basic Education Commission (UBEC), the NTI developed a teacher performance appraisal framework, which was implemented in 2022 to ensure that teachers meet professional standards and are supported through additional training where necessary.

8. Measures Taken to Increase Women in Leadership Positions in Education

Efforts to promote gender equity in leadership roles within the education sector have been prioritized. Various government bodies have initiated training programs aimed at empowering women to take on leadership roles within schools and educational institutions.

By 2024, NTI reported a 30% increase in women holding leadership positions in education, compared to 2020. Special leadership training programs were introduced for female teachers in both primary and secondary education levels (NTI Leadership Training Report, 2023).

Teacher training programs, coupled with initiatives for gender balance, performance monitoring, and salary improvements, have contributed to addressing key issues outlined in SDG target 4.c. These efforts align with the broader goal of ensuring qualified, well-supported, and motivated teachers are at the forefront of Nigeria's education system.

- What challenges were encountered in the education personnel?

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☒ Shortages of teaching staff | ☒ Low quality educational infrastructure and materials |
| ☒ Lack of qualified, trained and motivated teaching staff | ☒ High student – teacher ratio |
| ☒ Lack of training centres | |
| ☐ Other: | |

Inadequate Parental Support to Education

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

In the Nigerian education system, several challenges have been encountered in relation to education personnel, affecting the quality of teaching and the overall effectiveness of the system.

1. Shortages of Teaching Staff

One of the most pressing challenges in Nigeria's education system is the shortage of teaching staff, especially in rural and underserved areas. This issue has been exacerbated by the rapidly growing school-age population, leading to an imbalance in the supply and demand for teachers.

While urban areas may have a relatively sufficient number of teachers, many rural schools face critical shortages. Nigeria made huge efforts to address this challenge by offering flexible distance learning programmes and in-service training for teachers in rural areas. However, the shortage remains a significant barrier to achieving quality education for all, particularly in the northern regions, which are most affected by insurgency and displacement.

Another aspect of the shortage is the uneven distribution of teachers across states, with wealthier states able to attract more qualified personnel, while poorer or conflict-affected regions struggle to recruit and retain teachers.

2. Lack of Qualified, Trained, and Motivated Teaching Staff

The shortage of qualified and well-trained teachers has long been a challenge in Nigeria. Many teachers lack the requisite qualifications and professional development needed to teach effectively, particularly in STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering, and Mathematics) subjects.

In addressing this issue through its various teacher training programmes, such as the SMASE INSET (Strengthening Mathematics and Science Education), which aims to retrain teachers in these critical subjects. However, the number of unqualified or underqualified teachers remains high. For example, a 2023 report by the Teachers Registration Council of Nigeria (TRCN) indicated that about 20% of the current teaching workforce does not meet the minimum qualification requirements (Federal Ministry of Education, 2023).

Low salaries, inadequate working conditions, and limited career progression have contributed to a lack of motivation among many teachers. Although recent salary increases and improvements in teacher welfare have been introduced (as of 2022), teacher motivation, especially in under-resourced schools, remains a challenge.

3. Lack of Training Centres

Lack of adequate training centres remains a challenge, particularly for teachers in remote and conflict-affected areas.

Training Accessibility: Distance learning programs help to mitigate against this challenge, but physical training centres are still limited in some regions, especially in the North-East and North-West, where insecurity has led to the destruction of schools and educational infrastructure.

The shortage of well-equipped training centres hinders the effectiveness of professional development programmes, as many teachers are forced to travel long distances to attend training, which reduces participation rates.

4. Low Quality Educational Infrastructure and Materials

The poor state of educational infrastructure and learning materials in many Nigerian schools also presents a significant challenge to improving teacher quality and effectiveness.

Many schools, particularly in rural areas, lack basic facilities such as well-ventilated classrooms, teaching materials, and access to modern technology. This makes it difficult for teachers to create conducive learning environments and implement modern teaching techniques.

The availability of quality instructional materials remains a critical issue. Many schools rely on outdated textbooks, and the lack of access to digital tools further hampers the integration of technology in teaching and learning, which is essential for 21st-century education.

5. High Student-Teacher Ratio

The high student-teacher ratio in many Nigerian schools is another challenge that directly impacts the quality of education.

With the rising number of students, particularly in urban areas, many classrooms are overcrowded, sometimes with over 50 students per teacher. This makes it difficult for teachers to provide individualized attention, effectively manage classrooms, and assess students' needs.

High student-teacher ratios are particularly problematic in primary and secondary schools, where teachers are tasked with managing large numbers of students with limited resources. The UBEC 2023 report showed that some northern states have a ratio as high as 1 teacher for 100 students, severely affecting learning outcomes and teacher workload (UBEC Report, 2023).

6. Inadequate Parental Support to Education

A less discussed but significant challenge is the lack of adequate parental support for children's education. In many communities, especially rural or low-income areas, parents are either unable or unwilling to support their children's education due to economic pressures or cultural factors.

In some regions, especially in the northern part of Nigeria, cultural beliefs about early marriage or the value of girls' education can negatively impact school attendance and parental involvement. Teachers often struggle with high absenteeism and low parental engagement, which hinders the educational progress of students.

A research shows that parental involvement is a key factor in improving learning outcomes. However, changing these deeply rooted cultural and socio-economic factors remains a significant challenge.

The challenges encountered in the Nigerian education system, particularly with regard to education personnel, are multifaceted. Though significant strides in addressing these issues through teacher training and professional development programmes, the shortage of qualified teaching staff, lack of infrastructure, high student-teacher ratios, and insufficient parental support remain major obstacles. Efforts to overcome these challenges will require continued

investment in education, targeted policies to support rural and underserved areas, and a renewed focus on improving both teacher welfare and educational infrastructure.

3.3 Respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms

For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms. This is covered under SDG target 4.7.⁴¹ Please note that this section contributes to the general monitoring of Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation and that the future consultation on the 1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms // 2023 Recommendation on [...] will be used specifically for monitoring SDG4 indicator 4.7.1.

- Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (several items may be ticked):

☒ Curriculum includes human rights education.

☒ Educational and/or extracurricular activities are organized on human rights education.

☐ Other:

Commented [AC1]: Removed this answer as it was referring to the same things than the answer for the question below, and because it is more relevant for the next question, as developing the ticked answers

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

Measures Taken to Promote Human Rights Education in Nigeria

1. Curriculum Includes Human Rights Education

National Curriculum Reforms

The Federal Ministry of Education updated the curriculum to integrate human rights education comprehensively. This reform includes:

1. Introduction of basic concepts of human rights, including respect for others and the right to education, integrated into subjects like Social Studies and Civic Education.

2. Expanded modules on the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, international human rights conventions, and national human rights laws. These are included in subjects such as Government and Social Studies.

A 2022 review by the N noted that the curriculum updates aim to ensure that all students are exposed to human rights principles by the end of secondary education

Human Rights Education Content:

⁴¹ Which calls on states to "ensure that all learners acquire the knowledge and skills needed to promote sustainable development, including, among others, through education for sustainable development and sustainable lifestyles, human rights, gender equality, promotion of a culture of peace and non-violence, global citizenship and appreciation of cultural diversity and of culture's contribution to sustainable development".

- The updated curriculum incorporates human rights topics into the teaching of Civic Education, Social Studies, and other relevant subjects, ensuring that students receive a well-rounded education on human rights.
- The 2022 implementation report highlights that educational materials and teacher guides have been revised to support the new curriculum, with periodic assessments to ensure adherence and effectiveness (Federal Ministry of Education, 2021).

2. Educational and/or Extracurricular Activities Organized on Human Rights Education

Human Rights Clubs and Activities:

Many schools have established Human Rights Clubs to engage students in activities that promote awareness and advocacy.

These clubs facilitate:

- Regular debates and discussions on human rights issues, encouraging students to think critically and advocate for human rights.
- Initiatives such as the National Human Rights Essay Competition, which saw participation from over 300 schools in 2023, aimed at fostering students' understanding of human rights through creative expression (Human Rights Commission, 2023).

Clubs often organize community service projects focused on human rights, such as awareness campaigns and support for marginalized groups.

Collaborations with NGOs:

Partnerships with National Human Rights Commission (NHRC): In 2022, NHRC partnered with the Federal Ministry of Education to conduct regional workshops for educators and students. These workshops:

- Provided training on human rights issues and effective teaching methods. Over 5,000 educators participated, enhancing their capacity to teach human rights effectively (NHRC, 2022).
- Engaged communities through public awareness campaigns on human rights topics, leveraging both traditional and digital media to reach a broader audience.

3. Role of the National Teachers' Institute (NTI)

Teacher Training Programmes:

- NTI includes human rights education in its professional development programmes for teachers. This involves:
- Training teachers on how to incorporate human rights topics into their lessons, create inclusive classroom environments, and handle human rights issues sensitively.

As of 2024, NTI has trained over 20,000 teachers through these programmes. Feedback indicates that this training has improved teachers' ability to address human rights issues in their classrooms (NTI Annual Report, 2024).

Curriculum Development Support:

- *NTI provides expertise and recommendations for integrating human rights education into teacher training materials and curriculum guidelines. This collaboration helps:*
- *Align educational materials with human rights principles and national standards.*
- *Assist in the development of resources and guides that support teachers in delivering human rights education effectively (NERDC, 2023).*

Educational Materials and Resources:

- *Education stakeholders develop and distributes educational materials focused on human rights, including:*
- *Comprehensive guides and lesson plans that help teachers teach human rights concepts effectively.*

Additional resources such as multimedia content and interactive tools designed to engage students and enhance their understanding of human rights (Educational Resources Report, 2022).

Challenges and Considerations

While these measures represent significant progress, challenges such as resource limitations, socio-economic barriers, and varying levels of implementation across regions continue to impact the effectiveness of human rights education. Addressing these challenges requires ongoing efforts, including improved resource allocation, enhanced teacher training, and increased community involvement.

3.4 Non-state actors in education

For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision⁴².

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked):

- ☐ Legal provisions prohibiting discrimination on the grounds listed by the Convention/Recommendation⁴³ explicitly apply to non-state educational institutions. [Please specify:](#)

- ☒ Policies aim to guarantee that the development of non-state education does not generate discrimination and that non-state actors offer a relevant alternative (without supplanting public education). [Please specify:](#)

⁴² Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors.

⁴³ See: Article/Paragraph 1(1).

Non-Governmental Organisations' (NGOs) efforts in their provisions. There are frequent dialogues and stakeholders meeting to ensure healthy implementation of government education policies by non-state actors. Non-state actors are very innovative in responding to learning needs in the communities as stakeholders in planning of interventions.

☒ Legal provisions provide for the rights of the parents /legal guardians for providing religious and moral education for their children. [Please specify:](#)

Parents and guardians in Nigeria have the legal rights over their children and wards in all things including the supervision over their religion and morality.

☐ Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. [Please specify what is covered:](#)

- ✓ Registration
- ✓ State monitoring and inspections
- ✓ Qualifications of teachers
- ✓ Health and sanitation
- ✓ Safety (children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools)
- ✓ Infrastructure
- ✓ Curriculum
- ✓ Student-teacher ratio
- ✓ School fees
- ✓ School closures
- ✓ Other

It has been difficult to exactly ascertain the learning out-comes for different levels of education as learners' graduates from levels without attaining the expected national standards.

[- Please elaborate:](#)

These regulations are clearly state in Frameworks and Policy documents of the National Commission for Mass literacy, Adult and Non-Formal Education (NMEC).

The problems are the lack of sufficient resources for NMEC as the regulatory authority in Non-Formal Education to enforce or support the implementation and enforcements of legal rights

[- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision?](#)

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☒ Low quality educational infrastructure and materials | ☐ Issues in terms of equity and inclusion |
| ☒ Low number of professionally trained teachers | ☒ Weak government regulatory and monitoring capacity |
| ☒ High student – teacher ratio | |

☐ Other:

-Lack of access to opportunities for learners.☒

-Many learners are unable to take advantage of learning opportunities.☒

-The poor are too busy trying to meet daily financial needs of family☒

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

3.5 Digital education

Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion⁴⁴.

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked):

☒ Digital technology use in education is provided for in the legal framework.

Please indicate the relevant text and provisions:

In providing quality teacher education and promote digital literacy, Nigeria has taken significant steps to ensure the integration of digital education Through some MDAs. Between 2020 and 2024, NTI, in collaboration with the Commonwealth of Learning (COL), initiated a multimedia training programme aimed at enhancing teachers' ability to utilize digital tools for more engaging and effective teaching. This training focused on equipping teachers with the skills to create and use multimedia resources such as videos, animations, and podcasts in their lessons. Teachers learned how to integrate these resources into traditional classroom settings and digital platforms, thereby fostering a blended learning environment.

NTI, with support from the Universal Basic Education Commission (UBEC), launched the Learning Recovery Programme (LRP) in response to the learning disruptions caused by the COVID-19 pandemic, insecurity, and flooding. This program was pivotal in training around 375 master trainers across the country. These trainers were exposed to digital content creation, including how to develop podcasts for their lessons. This innovative approach aimed to help fill the gaps created by school closures, ensuring that learning could continue despite the physical and environmental challenges. Teachers were taught how to design and produce audio lessons that could be distributed to students via mobile phones, helping students in remote and underserved areas to catch up on missed learning opportunities.

These initiatives have had a profound impact on the integration of digital technology in education across Nigeria, which did not only improved teachers' digital literacy but also enhanced their capacity to deliver lessons in creative and interactive ways, fostering greater student engagement. Meanwhile, the Learning Recovery Programme enabled teachers to reach students who were otherwise left behind due to disruptions. By 2024, over 60% of the

⁴⁴ Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment.

schools involved in the LRP had adopted these new teaching methods, making significant strides in ensuring continuity and quality in education delivery.

However, despite these advances, challenges persist, particularly in ensuring equitable access to digital resources. Schools in rural areas continue to face difficulties in accessing reliable internet and digital devices, which hampers the full implementation of these programs

- ☒ Core legislations, policies, strategies or plans for the management, privacy, security, storage, transfer, use, and sharing of education data internally and externally to ensure the right to privacy of learners and education stakeholders (e.g., informed consent, transparent usage policies, etc.)
- ☒ Regulatory framework establishes minimum education standards for digital education to which all actors in education must comply.
- ☒ Measures to remove barriers to accessing digital content⁴⁵, including ensuring access to curriculum-aligned digital content available on free, public, multi-modal national platforms; high-quality content is available in core subjects, official national language(s), and designed with inclusive features to assist learners with disabilities.
- ☒ Digital skills incorporated into pre- and in-service teacher and leadership training curricula to create a culture of digital innovation and growth anchored in equity and inclusion that enables ongoing professional development for existing and emerging staff.
- ☒ Future-ready skills (including digital skills, data and AI competencies, critical thinking, etc.) integrated into formal curriculum at all levels of education
- ☒ Measures address the digital divide, including ensuring access to reliable electricity, meaningful internet connectivity at school and at home, devices suitable for learning and teaching, safe and sustainable software and secure platforms, and integrated education data systems.
- ☒ A well-established, sustainable, and cost-effective budget secured from a range of funding sources and intersectoral cooperation, supported by impact focused reporting linked to regional strategic goals.

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

In the Nigerian education system, key government bodies such as the Universal Basic Education Commission (UBEC) and other stakeholders, has taken several steps to implement policies and strategies that govern the management, privacy, and use of education data, as well as ensure the effective and equitable deployment of digital education. These measures are aligned with national and international guidelines, including ensuring the right to privacy of learners and education stakeholders.

1. Regulatory framework and minimum standards for digital education

The National Policy on Education (2021 revision) outlines the regulatory framework establishing minimum education standards for digital education. These standards are

⁴⁵ Lack of internet connection, basic infrastructure or devices.

designed to ensure that all actors in the education system, including schools and teachers, comply with key guidelines on data privacy, security, and management.

2. Measures to remove barriers to accessing digital content

Barriers to accessing digital content by making curriculum-aligned materials available on public, multi-modal platforms have been removed. These materials are available in core subjects and are designed with inclusive features to cater to learners with disabilities. The Learning Recovery Programme (LRP) introduced podcasts and other digital resources to ensure that students could access educational content remotely during disruptions such as the COVID-19 pandemic and insecurity. These resources were designed to be freely accessible and available in official national languages, ensuring that no learner was left behind due to language barriers or access to technology.

3. Incorporation of digital skills into teacher training curricula

Nigeria through FME has integrated digital skills into its pre-service and in-service teacher training curricula, fostering a culture of digital innovation and inclusion. This includes training on multimedia content creation, digital lesson delivery, and the use of virtual learning environments (VLEs). Teachers are trained on how to incorporate digital tools and platforms into classroom teaching as part of the Commonwealth of Learning (COL)-supported multimedia training and other digital literacy programs. Between 2021 and 2024, over 15,000 teachers were trained on these skills, helping to prepare them for a future-ready, digitally equipped teaching environment.

4. Integration of future-ready skills into the formal curriculum

The integration of future-ready skills, such as digital literacy, critical thinking, and AI competencies, has been a key focus of NTI's curriculum revision efforts. These skills are now incorporated at various levels of teacher education and are being emphasized across the education system, preparing teachers and students for the digital future. NTI's teacher training programs have embedded these competencies into both theoretical and practical components, ensuring that future teachers can navigate the challenges of the 21st-century classroom.

5. Addressing the digital divide

Recognizing the digital divide between rural and urban areas, measures to ensure access to reliable electricity, internet connectivity, and suitable devices for learning and teaching. These efforts are supported by collaborations with UBEC and other agencies, aimed at improving infrastructure in underserved areas. NTI's Learning Recovery Programme (LRP), for example, focused on the development of offline resources like podcasts, which allowed students to continue learning even without internet access.

6. Sustainable budget and intersectoral cooperation

A critical aspect of digital education initiatives is securing a sustainable and cost-effective budget. Funding for these programs comes from a mix of government allocations, donor agencies, and intersectoral cooperation with organizations like the Commonwealth of Learning (COL). to implement programs like the multimedia training for teachers and the Learning Recovery Programme, both of which have had measurable impacts on the education sector. It therefore ensures that digital education remains a priority in the sector's development agenda.

- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)?

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Lack of quality, curriculum-aligned digital teaching and learning content that supports flexible learning and teaching pathways | ☒ Limited access to internet and/or electricity |
| ☐ Lack of equity and inclusion in digital learning solutions | ☐ Limited access to hardware (devices, chargers, etc.) |
| ☒ Inadequate safety measures and IT support to respond to issues of child online safety or reduce cyber security risks | ☐ Difficulty in regulating the use of digital education solutions |
| ☐ Other: | ☒ Difficulty in sustainably financing digital education solutions at national scale |
| | ☐ Lack of digital skills development for meaningful use of digital technology in teaching practice |
| | ☐ Disjointed or fragmented solutions that are not centrally systematized or regulated |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

Challenges encountered in the provision of digital education in Nigeria:

1. Lack of quality, curriculum-aligned digital content

Despite the progress made in creating digital materials, there is still a shortage of curriculum-aligned digital teaching and learning content that supports flexible learning pathways. Teachers, especially those trained through NTI, have reported that the content available online does not fully cover the curriculum and is sometimes fragmented, making it difficult to ensure uniform learning outcomes across different regions.

2. Equity and inclusion in digital learning

There remains a lack of equity and inclusion in digital learning solutions, especially for students from rural or underserved areas. It was observed that learners in these areas often struggle with access to reliable internet, electricity, and suitable devices, which significantly hampers their participation in digital education initiatives. In contrast, students in urban areas have better access, leading to a growing digital divide.

3. Child online safety and cybersecurity risks

The increasing use of digital education has also raised concerns about online safety for children. Many teachers have reported inadequate IT support to tackle issues related to child online safety and cybersecurity risks. Schools and teachers lack sufficient guidelines or resources to protect students from online harassment or exposure to harmful content.

4. Limited access to internet and devices

One of the most prominent challenges is the limited access to internet and hardware (such as devices, chargers, and computers) for both teachers and students. Many schools and

households in rural Nigeria do not have consistent access to electricity or internet, which prevents full utilization of digital tools provided by educational bodies.

5. Sustainability and financing

Scaling digital education solutions at a national level has also proven difficult due to sustainable financing issues. Without consistent financial backing, many of the digital education solutions risk being underutilized or discontinued.

6. Digital skills development

Another challenge has been the lack of digital skills development among teachers. The overall digital literacy of many educators remains insufficient for the meaningful use of digital technology in teaching. This has resulted in underutilization of digital tools and a slow adoption rate, particularly in rural areas.

7. Fragmentation of digital solutions

Finally, digital education in Nigeria faces the challenge of disjointed or fragmented solutions. Many of the tools and platforms used are not centrally systematized or regulated, leading to inconsistencies in how digital education is delivered across different schools. This lack of coordination has made it difficult for teachers to implement a unified approach to digital learning.

These challenges reflect the broader issues faced in scaling and improving digital education in Nigeria, highlighting the need for a more coordinated, inclusive, and well-supported digital education framework.

4 Strengthening governance systems

For reference: The Education 2030 Framework for Action states "to ensure quality education and conditions for effective education outcomes, governments should strengthen education systems by instituting and improving appropriate, effective and inclusive governance and accountability mechanisms; quality assurance; management information systems; transparent and effective financing procedures and mechanisms; and institutional management arrangements, as well as ensure that robust, timely and accessible data are available" (para. 18).

- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked):

☒ Monitoring mechanisms to assess compliance with the right to education obligations, including through management information systems.

☐ Monitoring results are made public. Please provide the link:

EMIS/NEMIS ensure that there is compliance to Right to Education through provision of qualitative data for the education sector.

☒ Monitoring processes are participatory, inclusive and regular.

- ☒ Sector-wide and multisector approach is adopted to education governance.
- ☐ Financial resources are effectively allocated to prioritise the provision of free, quality, public education and are adequately budgeted for in government plans.
- ☐ The decision-making process for the allocation of resources to education is transparent.
- ☐ Ensuring crisis-sensitive and disaster risk-informed planning and programming, including the provision of quality education in emergencies.
- ☐ There is a certain degree of decentralization in favour of local public authorities and autonomy for schools to ensure context relevance of their teaching.

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance?

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☒ Budgetary constraints | ☐ Absence of supportive/ inconsistent/obsolete legal and policy environment |
| ☐ Lack of involvement of relevant stakeholders and lack of cooperation/coordination at different levels | ☒ Lack or weakness of monitoring systems – including the lack of reliable data |
| ☐ Poor dialogue with teachers' trade unions | |
| ☐ Other: | |

Independent Evaluation of the Effectiveness and Impact of SDG 4 Report – 2022 by FME, UNICEF.

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

III. Methods used to draw the attention of the various authorities in the country to the instruments

For reference: UNESCO governing bodies have underlined the need for awareness raising. Given the importance of normative action at the national level, wide dissemination of the Convention must be ensured, with the support of National Commissions for UNESCO.

- Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Several items may be ticked)

- ☐ Translation of the Convention/Recommendation into the national and possibly local languages

- ☐ Dissemination and advocacy of the core content of the Convention/Recommendation or the core principles of the right to education including through appropriate materials and resources
- ☐ Activities undertaken or supported by the National Commission to promote non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities and to foster debate on critical issues in relation to the rights enshrined in the instruments
- ☐ Other: